Reading and Writing Lesson: A Mysterious International Incident

Level: Intermediate English learners Skills: Speaking, reading comprehension, vocabulary, fact-finding, and writing Theme: A real international mystery

1. Warm-up: Four Questions

Discuss these questions with a partner before reading.

1. Have you ever heard of a mysterious incident that nobody could explain?
2. What would you do if you saw something strange in the sky?
3. Do you believe every mystery has a logical explanation? Why or why not?
4. Why do you think mysterious incidents attract international attention?

Vocabulary: Match each word with its meaning.

	Word	Meaning
	Investigators	E. People who try to discover the facts
	Puzzling	C. Went missing or could no longer be found
	Wreckage	B. Evidence or pieces of a broken object
	Disappeared	D. The remains of a damaged vehicle or structure
	Debris	A. Very difficult to understand or explain

2. Reading: The Mystery of Flight MH370

unresolved	signals	passengers	exploration	debris
destination	investigators	technology	answers	disappeared

On 8 March 2014, Malaysia Airlines Flight MH370 (1) ……. while travelling from Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia, to Beijing, China. There were 239 people on board, including (2) ……. and crew. The plane did not arrive at its (3) ……., and its disappearance became one of the world's most puzzling aviation mysteries. (4) ……. studied radar information and satellite (5) ……. to understand what had happened. The evidence suggested that the aircraft had changed direction and continued flying for several hours. Search teams from several countries looked for the missing plane, particularly in the southern Indian Ocean. Some aircraft (6) ……. was later found along Indian Ocean coastlines, but the main wreckage remained undiscovered. In 2025, Malaysia approved a new search involving Ocean Infinity, a company specialising in underwater (7) ……. .The search resumed in late December 2025 and continued into January 2026. The team used advanced underwater (8) ……. to examine parts of the ocean floor. However, the operation ended on 23 January 2026 without finding confirmed wreckage. The mystery remains (9) ……. . Investigators have not established exactly what happened to the aircraft or why it disappeared. Families of the passengers and crew continue to seek (10) ……. The case shows how difficult it can be to investigate an incident in the deep ocean, even with modern technology.

Reading activity: Unscramble the text

The sentences below describe the events in the reading, but they are in the wrong order. Ask students to put them in the correct order, from 1 to 6.

	Investigators studied radar data and satellite signals to learn what had happened.
	Some aircraft debris was found, but the main wreckage remained missing.
	The mystery remains unsolved, and the families continue to seek answers.
	A new underwater search took place from late 2025 into January 2026, but no confirmed wreckage was found.
	Search teams from different countries searched for the missing aircraft.
	The aircraft disappeared while flying from Malaysia to China with 239 people on board

4. Reading comprehension: Fact-finding chart

- Complete the chart using information from the reading.

Name of the incident	
Date of the incident	
Countries involved	
Number of people on board	
What happened?	
What evidence did investigators study?	
What did search teams discover?	
What happened during the latest search?	
Is the mystery solved?	
What can we learn from this incident?	

Follow-up questions

1. Why was Flight MH370's disappearance so puzzling?
2. What technology did investigators use to search for the aircraft?
3. Why do you think the mystery continues to attract international attention?

5. Writing activity 1:

Topic: An Unexplained Incident

Write a short paragraph using the prompts below. Organise your ideas into a beginning, middle, and ending.

Writing scaffold

Complete the prompts before writing your paragraph.

Paragraph 1 — Introduction

- What happened?
- When and where did it happen?
- Who was involved?

Paragraph 2 — The mystery

- What made the incident unusual?
- What did people or investigators discover?
- What difficulties did they face?

Paragraph 3 — Conclusion

- Was the mystery solved?
- How did people react?
- What do you think about the incident?

Useful expressions

- One day, something unusual happened...
- The incident took place in...
- At first, nobody understood...
- Investigators tried to discover...
- To everyone's surprise...
- Unfortunately, the mystery remained unsolved.
- In my opinion, this incident shows that...